

CLASS - 12th

SUBJECT - ENGLISH

PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

CLASS 12TH BIHAR BOARD – ENGLISH (RAINBOW PART 2)

CHAPTER 3: A PINCH OF SNUFF (BY MANOHAR MALGAONKAR)

 CHAPTER SUMMARY (IN 50 WORDS)

"A Pinch of Snuff" is a humorous short story by Manohar Malgaonkar. It revolves around Nanukaka, a clever and sharp-witted man who visits Delhi to meet some ministers. Through his extraordinary lies, quick thinking, and dramatic setups, he successfully fools politicians and achieves his goals smoothly.

 15 IMPORTANT SHORT SUBJECTIVE QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

Q1. Why was the narrator's mother excited when she heard about Nanukaka's arrival?

Ans: The narrator's mother was excited because Nanukaka was her brother, and she was very happy to welcome him to her house.

Q2. Why was the narrator reluctant to welcome Nanukaka?

Ans: The narrator was reluctant because he knew Nanukaka was coming to meet ministers, which meant he would stay for days and create unnecessary trouble.

Q3. How did Nanukaka travel in the second class carriage on a third class ticket?

Ans: Nanukaka traveled in the second class carriage by bribing the ticket collector (TC) at the station, managing it with his clever talk.

Q4. Who was Sohanlal Ratiram and why did Nanukaka visit him?

Ans: Sohanlal Ratiram was the Party Boss in Delhi. Nanukaka visited him to collect information and build contacts to reach the Welfare Minister.

Q5. How did Nanukaka impress Sohanlal Ratiram?



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Ans: Nanukaka impressed Sohanlal by dropping big names, pretending to be a close friend of Hazrat Barkat Ali (the Ambassador), and talking like a wealthy man.

Q6. Who was Hajrat Barkat Ali?

Ans: Hajrat Barkat Ali was the Indian Ambassador in Beirut, and Sohanlal Ratiram wanted to send his son to work with him.

Q7. Why did the Welfare Minister refuse to meet Nanukaka at first?

Ans: The Welfare Minister refused because Nanukaka did not have a prior appointment, and ministers in Delhi do not easily meet unknown visitors.

Q8. Why did Nanukaka need a luxury car, and how did he manage to get it?

Ans: Nanukaka needed a luxury car to look like a rich prince. He got it from Sikka Auto Dealers by pretending to be a wealthy buyer and bribing a dhobi.

Q9. What role did the dhobi play in Nanukaka's plan to get the car?

Ans: The dhobi was used to show a fake coat with a huge reward check inside, proving to the car dealer that Nanukaka was immensely rich.

Q10. What did Nanukaka write in the visitors' book at the Welfare Minister's house?

Ans: Nanukaka wrote himself down as the "Hereditary Astrologer to the Maharaja of Ninnore" and wrote the narrator's Delhi address.

Q11. Why did the Welfare Minister come to see Nanukaka at the narrator's house?

Ans: The minister came because he thought Nanukaka was a powerful royal astrologer who could solve political problems regarding the Ninnore marriage alliance.

Q12. What dress code did Nanukaka choose for the narrator when visiting the minister?

Ans: Nanukaka made the narrator wear a long black Jodhpur coat and a massive orange turban to look like a royal chauffeur.

Q13. What is a "pinch of snuff" and why does Nanukaka take it?

Ans: A pinch of snuff is a small amount of powdered tobacco inhaled through the nose. Nanukaka takes it whenever he is thinking deeply or making a new plan.

Q14. What does the narrator mean when he says "Nanukaka is a linguist"?

Ans: The narrator means that when Nanukaka gets extremely angry or excited, he stops speaking English or Hindi and starts swearing in his mother tongue, Marathi.

Q15. Is Nanukaka a genuine person or a fraud? Give your opinion.



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Ans: Nanukaka is a highly deceptive and manipulative character, but his sharp wit, courage, and humorous lies make him an entertaining person rather than a criminal.

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 50 OBJECTIVE QUESTIONS (QUESTION & OPTIONS IN SINGLE LINE)

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1. 'A Pinch of Snuff' is written by: (A) Bertrand Russell (B) Manohar Malgaonkar (C) Dr. Zakir Hussain (D) Pearl S. Buck
2. Manohar Malgaonkar is a well-known Indo-\_\_\_\_\_ novelist.: (A) American (B) African (C) Anglian / Indian (D) Australian
3. Important works of Manohar Malgaonkar include 'Distant Drum' and: (A) Hind Swaraj (B) A Bend in the Ganges (C) The Earth (D) Macbeth
4. 'A Pinch of Snuff' is structurally a/an: (A) Essay (B) Short Story (C) Drama (D) Poem
5. The tone of the story 'A Pinch of Snuff' is full of wit and: (A) tragedy (B) sorrow (C) humor (D) fear
6. Who was coming to Delhi to visit the narrator's family?: (A) Sohanlal (B) Minister (C) Nanukaka (D) Hazrat Ali
7. Nanukaka was the narrator's: (A) Paternal uncle (B) Maternal uncle (C) Brother (D) Father
8. The narrator of the story was a/an \_\_\_\_\_ on probation.: (A) Minister (B) Under Secretary (C) Doctor (D) Lawyer
9. Nanukaka's sister was the narrator's: (A) Mother (B) Aunt (C) Grandmother (D) Sister
10. Nanukaka wanted to stay in Delhi for at least: (A) a month (B) two or three days (C) a week (D) ten days
11. Nanukaka traveled in the second class carriage on a \_\_\_\_\_ class ticket.: (A) First (B) Third (C) AC (D) General
12. Nanukaka managed his travel without trouble by bribing the: (A) Station Master (B) Driver (C) Ticket Collector (TC) (D) Police
13. Nanukaka gave the narrator a basket which contained a: (A) puppy (B) kitten (C) bird (D) snake
14. Nanukaka had a striking personality with \_\_\_\_\_ hair.: (A) black (B) red (C) white / grey (D) blonde



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15. Nanukaka always wore an impressive \_\_\_\_\_ turban.: (A) green (B) blue (C) Deccani / Marathi (D) Punjabi
16. The narrator's mother changed the narrator's bedroom and gave it to: (A) the cat (B) Nanukaka (C) a minister (D) Sohanlal
17. Nanukaka went to Delhi primarily to meet some: (A) old friends (B) relatives (C) ministers (D) doctors
18. Meeting a minister in Delhi is described by the narrator as being more difficult than meeting: (A) God (B) a king (C) a friend (D) a teacher
19. Who was the Party Boss in Delhi?: (A) Hajrat Barkat Ali (B) Sohanlal Ratiram (C) Welfare Minister (D) Maharaja of Ninnore
20. Sohanlal Ratiram's son was: (A) Manohar (B) Lala ji (C) Ratiram (D) Sikka
21. Ratiram was supposed to go as a Trade Commissioner to: (A) London (B) Beirut (C) New York (D) Paris
22. Nanukaka talked about his close friendship with the Ambassador named: (A) Lala ji (B) Hazrat Barkat Ali (C) Ratiram (D) Sikka
23. Nanukaka impressed Sohanlal by loudly talking about his fake: (A) cars (B) land and royal connections (C) education (D) gold
24. Nanukaka took a pinch of \_\_\_\_\_ whenever he was deep in thought.: (A) salt (B) sugar (C) snuff (D) pepper
25. The name of the car dealer company was: (A) Maruti Auto (B) Tata Motors (C) Sikka Auto Dealers (D) Delhi Car Hub
26. Nanukaka hired a grand luxury car which was a: (A) Fiat (B) Ford (C) Chevrolet (D) Ambassador
27. To impress the car dealer, Nanukaka used a poor: (A) driver (B) dhobi (C) servant (D) farmer
28. Nanukaka dropped a fake reward check of \_\_\_\_\_ rupees in his old coat pocket.: (A) 500 (B) 1000 (C) 5000 (D) 10000
29. The dhobi honestly returned the fake check to Nanukaka in front of the: (A) Minister (B) Car Manager (C) Narrator (D) Police
30. Nanukaka acted as if a thousand rupees check was a \_\_\_\_\_ matter for him.: (A) very huge (B) very small / casual (C) dangerous (D) illegal
31. The narrator was forced by Nanukaka to act as his liveried: (A) Secretary (B) Cook (C)



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Chauffeur / Driver (D) Bodyguard

32. At the Welfare Minister's house, Nanukaka asked for the: (A) Money (B) Food (C) Visitors' book (D) Telephone
33. Nanukaka introduced himself in the book as the Hereditary Astrologer to the Maharaja of: (A) Indore (B) Ninnore (C) Gwalior (D) Jaipur
34. The Welfare Minister was deeply worried about the marriage of his: (A) son (B) daughter (C) sister (D) brother
35. The princess of Ninnore was getting married to the prince of: (A) Bhopal (B) Gwalior (C) Ninnore (D) None of these
36. Seeing the high status of the royal astrologer, the Welfare Minister visited Nanukaka at: (A) the office (B) the station (C) the narrator's house (D) a hotel
37. Nanukaka's character shows that he is a master of: (A) science (B) cooking (C) clever lies and management (D) poetry
38. Whenever Nanukaka faced an emergency, he turned to his mother tongue: (A) Hindi (B) Gujarati (C) Marathi (D) Punjabi
39. "A Pinch of Snuff" highlights the superficial life of: (A) villagers (B) Delhi politicians and bureaucrats (C) poets (D) children
40. The narrator was always afraid that Nanukaka's lies would be: (A) published (B) caught / exposed (C) rewarded (D) forgotten
41. Nanukaka's silver snuff-box was made of: (A) plastic (B) silver (C) gold (D) wood
42. The color of the turban Nanukaka tied around the narrator's head was: (A) white (B) orange / saffron (C) black (D) blue
43. Nanukaka belonged to which state originally?: (A) Bihar (B) Maharashtra (C) Punjab (D) Uttar Pradesh
44. Who was the person who refused to give his daughter to the Prince of Ninnore?: (A) Welfare Minister (B) Sohanlal (C) Hazrat Ali (D) Maharaja of Ninnore
45. The narrator found Nanukaka's arrival announcements quite: (A) pleasant (B) shocking / depressing (C) funny (D) musical
46. Nanukaka left the narrator's house after successfully fooling the: (A) TC (B) Welfare Minister (C) Dhobi (D) Auto Dealer
47. Manohar Malgaonkar's writing style is full of rapid: (A) data (B) action and suspense (C) sadness (D) philosophy



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48. In the story, the character who speaks the least is the: (A) Mother (B) Nanukaka (C) Narrator (D) Dhobi

49. "A Pinch of Snuff" is an excellent example of a: (A) dark tragedy (B) satirical comic story (C) sci-fi story (D) historical drama

50. At the end of the story, the narrator hopes that Nanukaka never gets caught by the: (A) Mother (B) Minister (C) Dhobi (D) TC



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